

Readiness Checklist

A quick snapshot based on the five official Cyber Essentials technical controls.

CHECK YOUR CURRENT POSITION

Tick one answer for each control

YES

NO

1. Firewalls

Create a security filter between the internet and your network, with firewall protection enabled and securely configured.

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2. Secure configuration

Set up devices, software and cloud services securely to minimise the ways a cyber criminal could gain access.

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3. Security update management

Apply relevant security updates promptly to prevent known software vulnerabilities being used as an access point.

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4. User access control

Control who can access your data and services, and give each person only the access needed for their role.

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5. Malware protection

Use appropriate protection to identify and stop viruses or other malicious software before they can cause harm.

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ASSET INVENTORY WILL BE NEEDED

Before certification, identify the devices, software and cloud services included in scope. A detailed asset list can be prepared during your readiness review.

YOUR READINESS SNAPSHOT

Count your YES answers

Use page 2 to spot common hidden gaps.

5/5

STRONG START

4/5

NEARLY READY

0-3

REVIEW GAPS

Top 10 Issues We Find

These are common areas to review before starting a Cyber Essentials assessment.

1 MFA not enabled everywhere

MFA may cover email but not every administrator, VPN, remote-access or cloud account.

2 Shared user accounts

Shared logins reduce accountability and make access harder to control.

3 Local administrator rights

Daily users may have elevated permissions they do not need.

4 Unsupported systems or software

Old operating systems, applications or devices may no longer receive security updates.

5 Security updates applied too late

Relevant security fixes may not be deployed within the required timeframe.

6 Incomplete asset inventory

The organisation cannot confidently identify every device, service and application in scope.

7 Weak administrator account controls

Privileged accounts may be used for everyday work or lack appropriate protection.

8 Remote-access tools overlooked

Support and remote-control tools may be present without being included in the review.

9 Unnecessary software and services

Unused applications, accounts or services may remain enabled.

10 Default or insecure configuration

Default credentials and weak security settings may still be in place.

READY TO KNOW EXACTLY WHERE YOU STAND?

Book your free 1-hour Cyber Essentials readiness review

Identify gaps | Confirm scope | Leave with a clear action plan

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